

Photographs by CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

HOW TO MAKE TAMIL NADU THE INDUSTRIAL HUB OF THE COUNTRY

TAKEAWAYS

1. Aim for a growth rate of 15 per cent in manufacturing and attract investments to the tune of Rs 10 lakh crore.
2. Focus on existing investors as they will be able to attract more.
3. Address issues related to land acquisition sensitively and quicken approvals.
4. Finetune the 2021 Tamil Nadu fintech policy so that the FinTech City planned at Nandambakkam evolves as the fintech capital of India.
5. Reduce the skill gap and provide more employment, even as the state shifts focus from engineering to vocational programmes.
6. Promote greater technology in the agriculture sector and help support MSMEs through financial programmes.

best performing big state with consistent and credible performance across parameters, even in the wake of the devastating Covid-19 pandemic.

On March 4, India Today held the Tamil Nadu First Conclave in Chennai, the first in its series of individual conclaves to be held across all states in India. "The idea," said India Today Group Editorial Director (Publishing) Raj Chengappa in his introductory remarks, "is to provide a forum to debate key development issues of a particular state, invite the best strategists to exchange their views and come up with out-of-the-box solutions to speed up the states's progress and provide prosperity and happiness to its citizens".

With a gross state domestic product of $297 billion (Rs 22.44 lakh crore), he added, Tamil Nadu is India's second-largest economy. Chief minister M.K. Stalin's dream now is to make Tamil Nadu a trillion-dollar economy by 2030, with a focus on boosting manufacturing and services while giving priority to government's welfare measures to ensure social justice and, what Stalin calls, the Dravidian model. And for this, the vibrant state with its population of 84.96 million can leverage its several strengths.

CHIEF MINISTER M.K. STALIN WANTS TAMIL NADU TO BECOME A TRILLION-DOLLAR ECONOMY BY 2030

In the industrial sector, Tamil Nadu has always been a front runner. In fact, 17 per cent of all industries in the country are located in the state. Chennai alone accounts for 60 per cent of the country's automotive exports, making it India's largest automobile cluster. Tamil Nadu also accounts for about 70 per cent of India's passenger vehicle exports and 45 per cent of the total auto exports from India. It is now among the top 10 auto manufacturing hubs in the world.

In textiles, too, Tamil Nadu is a leader. Coimbatore is the hub of the textile industry in south India, housing around 15 per cent of the textile mills in the country. Plus, the state has the largest spinning industry in India, accounting for 40 per cent of the total production.